

Simtora Technologies, Inc.

Human Resources Policy Manual

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Applies to	All U.S. employees of Simtora Technologies, Inc. ("Simtora" or "the Company"), including the San Francisco headquarters. Employees of the subsidiaries in Pakistan, Germany, France, Australia and the United Kingdom are covered by the Global People Supplement (SIM-HR-002) and their Country HR Manual
Related manuals	Global People Supplement (SIM-HR-002); Country HR Manuals (SIM-HR-101 Pakistan, SIM-HR-102 Germany, SIM-HR-103 France, SIM-HR-104 Australia, SIM-HR-105 United Kingdom); International Operations Supplement (SIM-GLB-001); IT Policy Manual (SIM-IT-001); Finance and Accounting Manual (SIM-FIN-001); Procurement Policy Manual (SIM-PRC-001); Code of Ethics and Compliance Manual (SIM-CMP-001); Facilities and Office Administration Manual (SIM-FAC-001)

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Introduction

This Human Resources Policy Manual is the central reference for all managers and employees at Simtora Technologies, Inc. It applies to every U.S. location where the Company does business, including remote employees, and sets out how we recruit, employ, develop, support and part ways with our people.

Our people principles

Every policy here follows from six commitments. Simtora will:

1. Hire talented people whose curiosity and craft help deliver our business goals.
2. Communicate standards and expectations clearly, including how performance is judged.
3. Value diversity and provide equal employment opportunity in a workplace built on mutual respect.
4. Treat all employees, contractors, customers and partners professionally and without discrimination.
5. Provide safe, flexible and effective working conditions, on-site and remote.

6. Offer competitive pay, benefits and growth opportunities in the technology labor market.

How to use this manual

- **Status of this manual.** This manual is a guide. It is not a contract of employment and does not promise employment for any period (see 1.2). Nothing in it alters at-will employment.
- **Changes.** Simtora may add, change or withdraw any policy at any time, with notice to employees through normal channels (email and the HR intranet). The version on the HR intranet is always the current one.
- **Conflicts.** Where this manual conflicts with applicable law, the law governs. Where it conflicts with a signed written agreement authorized by the CEO, that agreement governs. State or local law that is more generous to employees overrides a policy here to the extent of the difference.
- **Supplements.** Teams may add procedures specific to their work, but those may not reduce any right or protection in this manual.
- **Questions.** Ask your manager first, then HR (hr@simtora.example).
- **Acknowledgement.** Every employee signs the acknowledgement in Appendix A at onboarding and again when this manual is materially revised.

Locations outside the United States

Simtora is headquartered in San Francisco, California, and has R&D centers in Lahore (Pakistan), Berlin (Germany), Paris (France), Sydney (Australia) and London (United Kingdom), each run by a local subsidiary. **This manual is written for U.S. employees.** Its references to U.S. law and practice (at-will employment, FLSA, FMLA, PTO, COBRA, 401(k), Form I-9 and similar) do not apply outside the United States. Employees there follow the **Global People Supplement (SIM-HR-002)**, which says which parts of this manual apply globally, and their **Country HR Manual**. California and San Francisco rules for headquarters employees are in SIM-HR-002, Part 2. Where this manual says "state law", employees in California should also read that Part.

Roles and responsibilities (summary)

Role	Main responsibilities under this manual
Employees	Read and follow policies; behave professionally; raise concerns promptly; protect Company information and assets.
Managers	Apply policies fairly and consistently; run onboarding, reviews and corrective action; act immediately on any complaint they hear; keep HR informed.
HR (People Operations)	Own and maintain the policies; advise managers; run recruiting, onboarding, payroll coordination, leave, investigations and offboarding; keep records; ensure legal compliance.
Executive Team	Approve policy; model the standards; hear final-stage appeals.
CEO	Final approval of the manual; hears matters involving Executive Team members together with the Board.

Part 1 – Employing Staff

1.1 Recruitment and Hiring

Purpose. To attract and select people with the skills, experience and values to help Simtora succeed, through a fair, consistent, merit-based process.

Scope. All external and internal hiring, including full-time, part-time, fixed-term, intern and (where relevant) contractor engagements.

Policy

Requisition and approval

- Every hire needs an approved headcount requisition: job title, level, reporting line, compensation band, location/work arrangement and business justification. Approval follows the matrix in Appendix E.

- Each role has a written job description listing main duties, required and preferred qualifications, physical or technical demands, and FLSA classification (see 1.2).

Advertising and sourcing

- Roles are posted on the Simtora careers page and appropriate job boards, and generally shared internally first or at the same time. Sourcing must not be confined to channels that reach only one type of candidate.
- Postings state the pay range where required by law (e.g., Colorado, California, Washington, New York City and other jurisdictions with pay transparency rules). As a matter of policy, Simtora includes a good-faith pay range in all U.S. postings.
- Roles may be restricted to internal candidates only where the business reason is documented.

Fair selection

- Selection is based on job-related criteria: skills, experience, demonstrated ability and potential. We assess using structured interviews with a common question set and scoring rubric.
- Hiring decisions must not consider, directly or indirectly, any characteristic protected by law (see 4.1).
- Technical assessments must be job-relevant, reasonable in length, and accessible. Candidates may request accommodations for any part of the process; HR handles these confidentially.
- Interview panels are trained and, wherever possible, include more than one interviewer from more than one team. No manager may interview or decide on a candidate they are related to or in a close personal relationship with (see 5.5).
- Candidates are asked to disclose any relatives employed by Simtora. Canvassing of Simtora staff to influence a hiring decision is not permitted.

Salary history and criminal history

- Simtora does not ask candidates about their salary history where prohibited by law, and as a matter of policy does not use salary history to set pay.
- Criminal history is asked about only after a conditional offer, is considered only as permitted by federal, state and local "fair chance" laws (including individualized assessment and any required notices), and is considered only where relevant to the role.

Offers and pre-employment checks

- Offers are issued only by HR, in writing, and are conditional on: verification of identity and eligibility to work in the U.S. (Form I-9, and E-Verify where required or used); satisfactory reference checks; and, for roles with system or financial access, a background check run with the candidate's written consent under the Fair Credit Reporting Act. Any adverse action based on a background report follows FCRA pre-adverse and adverse action steps.
- Offer letters state that employment is at will (see 1.2), the role, pay, classification, start date, and any conditions. They do not promise a fixed term.
- Offers that require work authorization sponsorship are handled by HR with immigration counsel.

Employee referrals

- Employees are encouraged to refer candidates. Referral bonuses are paid per the current referral program schedule after the referred hire completes 90 days of employment. Referred candidates get the same process as all others.

Records

- Application materials, interview notes and assessment results are retained for at least one year after the hiring decision (longer where law requires) and kept confidential.

Responsibilities

- **Hiring manager:** defines need and criteria, interviews fairly, documents the rationale.
- **HR:** administers the process, ensures compliance, issues offers, runs checks.
- **Finance:** confirms budget for new headcount.

1.2 Employment Classification and At-Will Employment

At-will employment

Employment at Simtora is **at will**. Either the employee or Simtora may end the employment relationship at any time, with or without cause or notice, subject to applicable law. Only the

CEO, in a signed written agreement, may change at-will status. No manager, policy, handbook, practice, offer letter or verbal statement creates a contract for a fixed term or limits Simtora's right to end employment. (Where state law or a written agreement provides otherwise, that law or agreement governs.)

Classification

Each role is classified at hire under the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) and state law:

- **Exempt (salaried):** paid a salary that meets the applicable federal and state threshold and performs exempt duties (executive, administrative, professional, computer professional, etc.). Not eligible for overtime pay.
- **Non-exempt (hourly):** eligible for overtime and subject to meal and rest break and timekeeping rules.

Classification is determined by HR, based on duties and pay, and reviewed when duties change. An employee who believes they have been misclassified should contact HR; Simtora will review the question promptly and will not retaliate.

Employment categories

Category	Description	Benefits eligibility
Regular full-time	Scheduled for 30+ hours/week on an ongoing basis	Eligible for all benefits, subject to plan terms
Regular part-time	Scheduled for fewer than 30 hours/week on an ongoing basis	Eligible for PTO (pro-rated), sick leave, and benefits as plan terms and law require
Fixed-term / temporary	Hired for a defined project or period	Eligible as stated in the offer letter and as law requires
Intern	Enrolled or recent students in a defined program	Paid per law; limited benefits
Contractor / consultant	Independent business, engaged under a services agreement	

1.3 Onboarding and Induction

Purpose. To help every new hire become comfortable, productive and connected quickly, and to reduce early turnover and misunderstanding.

Scope. All new employees, including rehires and internal transfers into a new team (light version).

Policy

Simtora believes every new employee must receive a timely and structured induction. HR and the hiring manager share responsibility.

Before day one (HR, hiring manager, IT)

- Complete new hire paperwork: Form I-9 (Section 1 by day one; Section 2 within three business days), Form W-4 and state equivalent, direct deposit, emergency contacts, benefits enrollment packet, and the policy acknowledgement (Appendix A).
- IT provisions laptop, accounts, multi-factor authentication, and role-based access per the IT Policy. Equipment is shipped to remote hires to arrive before the start date.
- The manager prepares a 30/60/90-day plan, confirms a buddy, and briefs the team.
- HR sends a welcome note to the new hire and a welcome announcement to the company.

Day one

- A short, well-prepared welcome session: introductions, schedule for the first week, where to get help. Avoid information overload on day one.
- Workplace or virtual tour; for hybrid staff, how on-site and remote norms work (see 5.2).
- Security basics: passwords, MFA, device rules, phishing awareness, and acceptable use (see 1.9).

First week

- HR-led induction: Simtora history, vision and values, organization chart, benefits, key policies (conduct, anti-harassment, confidentiality, security, PTO, hybrid work), and how to raise concerns.
- Required trainings assigned and completed within 30 days (see 7.1): security awareness, harassment prevention, code of conduct, data privacy; state-mandated training where applicable.

First 90 days

- **Buddy program.** Each new hire is paired with a peer buddy (not the manager) to answer everyday questions about tools, norms and culture. Buddies are volunteers and get recognition for the role.
- Weekly one-on-ones with the manager; a 30-day and 60-day check-in; and the 90-day review (see 1.4).
- New hires complete a short feedback survey at 30 and 90 days so HR can improve onboarding.

Induction objectives

- Settle new employees quickly so they become productive members of the team.
- Reinforce the motivation new hires arrive with.
- Reduce early turnover, lateness and avoidable performance problems.
- Ensure a safe working environment and clear expectations from the start.
- Reduce the cost of repeat recruitment and lost productivity.

HR commitment. HR maintains the onboarding checklist (Appendix B), provides guidance and training for managers, and promptly resolves problems in the process.

1.4 Introductory (Probation) Period

Purpose. To give both the employee and Simtora a structured period to assess fit: the employee learns the role and culture; the manager learns the employee's strengths and needs.

Scope. All new regular employees. Directors and above, and employees rehired within 12 months into the same role, may be exempted in writing by HR.

Policy

- The introductory period is **90 calendar days** from the start date.
- The introductory period does **not** guarantee employment for any length of time and does **not** change at-will status. Simtora may end employment at any time, before or after the period ends. Completing the period does not create a contract.
- Employees on introductory status accrue PTO and sick leave from day one, but may use accrued PTO only after 30 days of employment unless the manager approves earlier (sick and safe leave may be used as permitted by law, from the date state law allows). Medical and other benefits begin per plan terms.
- Employees on introductory status are covered by every policy in this manual, including anti-discrimination, anti-harassment and anti-retaliation rules.

Review process

1. **Days 1–14:** manager sets written objectives and explains expectations.
2. **Day 30 and 60:** check-in conversations are documented.
3. **Day 75:** the manager completes the Probation Review Form (Appendix C) and discusses it with the employee; the employee may add comments. The Department Head countersigns and HR reviews.
4. **Day 90:** HR confirms one of three outcomes:
 - **Confirmed** – introductory period successfully completed.
 - **Extended** – once, for up to 30 days, where specific and documented improvement is needed. The extension letter states the goals and the review date. An extension may also be used to cover a long absence during the period.
 - **Not confirmed** – employment ends. This decision is made before the period expires, is reviewed by HR, and is communicated in person where possible.

What we look at

- Knowledge, skills and deliverables for the role.
- Quality and reliability of work, including engineering practices where relevant.
- Collaboration with teammates and partners; communication.
- Adaptability and learning speed.
- Adherence to Simtora values, security practices and policies.

HR checks that the employee received the resources, supervision and clear expectations needed to succeed before any "not confirmed" decision.

1.5 Pay and Payroll

Purpose. To set out how employees are paid accurately, on time and in compliance with wage-and-hour laws.

Policy

Pay frequency and method

- Employees are paid **bi-weekly** (26 pay dates a year) by direct deposit. Where state law requires a different frequency or method for any employee, Simtora follows the law. Pay is issued on Friday; if a Friday is a bank holiday, pay is issued the prior business day.
- Each pay statement shows gross pay, hours (for non-exempt), deductions and net pay. Employees should review it and report errors to HR within 30 days; errors are corrected promptly (and underpayments in the next pay cycle or sooner).
- Employees update direct-deposit, tax-withholding and address details through the HR system. Bank changes need at least **7 days** before pay day to take effect.

Deductions

- Simtora makes only deductions that are required by law (taxes, garnishments, court-ordered support), or that the employee has voluntarily authorized in writing (benefits contributions, 401(k), commuter benefits, etc.).
- Simtora does **not** deduct from pay for Company property loss, damage or errors unless the law permits it and the employee has given separate written authorization. Deductions never reduce pay below minimum wage or, for exempt employees, reduce the predetermined salary except as the FLSA allows.
- If Simtora overpays an employee, HR will tell the employee in writing and arrange repayment in a manner permitted by state law, typically by agreement on a schedule.

Pay reviews

- Compensation is reviewed **annually** in the Company's merit cycle (and at promotion). Reviews consider role scope, performance, market data and internal pay equity. A review does not guarantee an increase.
- Simtora conducts an annual pay-equity analysis and corrects unjustified differences.
- Employees are free to discuss their own pay and working conditions with each other. Simtora will not retaliate against employees for doing so. (Employees whose job includes access to other people's pay data, such as HR and payroll, may not disclose it except as law allows.)

Overtime (non-exempt employees)

- Non-exempt employees must record all time worked and be paid overtime at 1.5x the regular rate for hours over 40 in a workweek, and as state law requires (e.g., daily overtime in California).
- Overtime must be approved by the manager in advance. All time worked must be recorded and paid, including unapproved overtime; unapproved overtime may be subject to corrective action, but it is always paid.
- Non-exempt employees must not work "off the clock," including checking email or responding to messages outside scheduled hours without recording the time.

Bonuses and equity

- **Annual performance bonus:** eligible roles participate in a discretionary bonus plan governed by the plan document. Bonuses are not guaranteed, are based on Company and individual performance, and typically require active employment on the payment date (unless law or the plan provides otherwise).
- **Equity:** eligible roles may receive stock options or restricted stock units under the Equity Incentive Plan and individual award agreements, which govern vesting, exercise and separation.
- **Sales incentives:** roles with commission or sales incentives have a separate written plan.

Payroll calendar is published on the HR intranet each January.

1.6 Expense Reimbursement

Purpose. To ensure employees are reimbursed promptly for reasonable, pre-approved business expenses, and that Company funds are used responsibly.

Policy

- Simtora reimburses **reasonable, necessary and pre-approved** business expenses incurred in performing your job. (See 8.1 for travel; 7.4 for equipment and stipends.)
 - Submit expense reports in the expense system within **30 days** of the expense with itemized receipts for anything over \$25 and a business purpose for each item.
 - Reports are approved by the manager, then reviewed by Finance. Approved reimbursements are paid within 10 business days, on the next payroll or by separate payment.
 - Employees may not approve their own expenses or those of someone more senior. Managers must not approve expenses without reviewing receipts.
 - Personal expenses must not be charged to Company cards. Any accidental charge must be reported to Finance and repaid within 30 days.
 - Where state law requires reimbursement of necessary expenses (for example, in California), Simtora will reimburse them regardless of approval status, so long as they were reasonable and necessary.
 - False or inflated claims, duplicate claims or altered receipts are serious misconduct (see 2.3).
-

1.7 Standards of Business Conduct

Purpose. To set out the standards of honesty, fairness and professionalism expected of everyone at Simtora, inside and outside work where it affects the Company.

Scope. All employees, and (as contract terms require) contractors, consultants, interns and agency workers.

General duties

Employees are expected to:

- Be ready and willing to work and to do their job competently and with reasonable care.
- Follow lawful and reasonable instructions about how, when and where work is done.
- Work for Simtora during paid working time and use that time for Simtora's business.
- Protect Company property, information and reputation.
- Act honestly and in good faith, and disclose information relevant to the Company's business, such as a conflict of interest or a security incident.
- Be respectful to colleagues, customers and partners, in person and online.
- Cooperate with investigations and provide truthful information.
- Comply with all laws and regulations that apply to their work.

Gifts, hospitality and entertainment

- Employees must not solicit gifts, payments or favors from any customer, supplier or other business contact.
- Gifts of **nominal value** (a maximum of **\$50** per source per year) and ordinary business meals and entertainment that are infrequent, reasonable and have a clear business purpose may be accepted or given. Anything beyond this requires the approval of the Department Head and must be recorded with HR or Compliance.
- Cash and cash equivalents (gift cards) may never be accepted or given.
- Gifts to or from government officials are subject to strict legal limits and require pre-approval from the Legal/Compliance function.
- Employees involved in procurement or selecting vendors must not accept any gift during an active tender or evaluation.
- If in doubt, politely decline and ask.

Anti-bribery and corruption

- Simtora prohibits bribery in any form, including facilitation payments. A bribe is anything of value offered, promised, given or received to improperly influence a decision or to reward improper performance.
- This applies to dealings with the public and private sectors, and to work done through agents or third parties. Simtora complies with the U.S. Foreign Corrupt Practices Act and other applicable anti-corruption laws.

- Offering, paying, requesting or accepting a bribe is gross misconduct and may also be a crime.

Conflicts of interest

A conflict of interest arises when personal interests, or those of a family member or close associate, could influence or appear to influence your duty to Simtora. Common examples:

- Working for, consulting to, or holding a material financial interest in a competitor, customer, supplier or partner.
- Hiring, supervising or influencing the pay, performance review or promotion of a relative or someone you are in a romantic relationship with (see 5.5).
- Serving on the board of an outside company or organization where that role could conflict with your duties (service on non-profit boards is usually fine but should be disclosed).
- Using Company property, information or business opportunities for personal gain.
- Accepting gifts or favors not available to all employees.

Disclosure. Employees must disclose any actual or potential conflict **in writing** to their manager and HR before engaging in the activity or as soon as they learn of it. HR and Compliance decide how to manage it and record the outcome. Disclosed conflicts that are managed appropriately are not misconduct; undisclosed conflicts are.

Political and civic activity

Employees are free to take part in political and civic life on their own time and with their own resources. Employees must make clear they act in a personal capacity and must not use Company name, funds, time or resources for political purposes without written approval from a senior executive and Legal.

Social media and public statements

- Employees who speak publicly about Simtora (including on social media) must make clear they speak for themselves unless authorized.
- Do not disclose confidential information or customer data, and do not harass or discriminate against others online.

- Only authorized spokespeople speak to the media for Simtora; refer media queries to Communications.
- This policy does not restrict employees from discussing wages, hours or working conditions, or engaging in other legally protected activity.

Identification and access

Employees must wear or carry their Simtora ID in Company offices, follow visitor procedures, and must not lend badges or access credentials.

Reporting breaches

Employees who know of or reasonably suspect a breach of these standards should report it to their manager, HR or through the channels in 3.3. Simtora protects good-faith reporters from retaliation.

Consequences

Breaching these standards may lead to corrective action up to and including termination, and where appropriate, legal action or referral to authorities. These standards form part of the conditions of employment.

1.8 Confidentiality, Intellectual Property and Outside Activities

Confidential information

- **Definition.** Confidential information is non-public information about Simtora, its customers, partners or employees that an employee learns through their work, including source code, architecture, product roadmaps, security details, customer data and lists, pricing, financials, personnel data of others, and trade secrets.
- **Duty.** Employees may not use or disclose confidential information except as needed to do their job, during and after employment. Share it only with those with a business need to know. Do not discuss it in public places or unsecured channels.

- **Agreement.** Every employee signs the Confidentiality and Invention Assignment Agreement as a condition of employment.
- **Protected rights.** Nothing in this policy or any agreement prohibits or restricts employees from: discussing or disclosing wages, benefits or working conditions; reporting possible violations of law to, filing a charge with, or participating in an investigation by any government agency (e.g., EEOC, NLRB, SEC, OSHA, Department of Labor); making disclosures protected by whistleblower laws; or testifying truthfully. No prior notice to or approval from Simtora is needed for these activities.
- **Defend Trade Secrets Act notice.** Under 18 U.S.C. § 1833(b), an individual will not be held criminally or civilly liable under any federal or state trade secret law for disclosing a trade secret (a) in confidence to a federal, state or local government official or to an attorney, solely to report or investigate a suspected violation of law, or (b) in a complaint or other document filed under seal in a lawsuit or other proceeding.

Intellectual property

- Work product created within the scope of employment, using Company resources or relating to Simtora's business (including code, designs, documents, inventions and improvements) belongs to Simtora, as set out in the Confidentiality and Invention Assignment Agreement.
- Employees must disclose such inventions promptly to their manager and help Simtora protect them.
- **Carve-out.** The agreement does not assign inventions that an employee developed entirely on their own time, without using Company equipment, supplies, facilities or confidential information, and that do not relate to Simtora's business or result from work performed for Simtora. State law limits on invention assignment (for example, California Labor Code § 2870 and similar laws in other states) apply and are summarized in the agreement.
- **Open-source.** Employees may contribute to open-source projects on Company time only if approved by their manager and the Legal/Engineering leadership, and must follow the open-source policy on licensing and code release. Personal open-source contributions on personal time that are unrelated to Simtora's business, done with personal equipment, are permitted; disclose them if they could overlap with Simtora's products.
- **Third-party IP.** Do not bring to Simtora, or use in your work, confidential information or code belonging to a former employer or any third party, and do not copy software

or content without a license.

Outside employment and other activities

- Employees may hold a second job, consult, or run a side business **only if** it: (a) does not conflict with Simtora's interests or compete with it; (b) does not use Company time, equipment, information or IP; (c) does not affect performance or availability; and (d) is disclosed in writing to the manager and HR beforehand, with approval on file.
- Employees in engineering, security or product roles must get prior written approval for paid outside technology work.
- Approval can be withdrawn if a conflict emerges.
- Volunteer and charitable activity is encouraged; see 7.3 for the volunteer time program.

Company property and assets

- Computers, phones, accounts, software, data, credit cards and supplies are provided for Company business. Reasonable, limited personal use is allowed if it does not interfere with work, incur cost, breach policy or create risk.
 - Employees must protect Company assets against loss, theft, misuse and unauthorized access: lock devices, keep them in sight or secured, and never leave them unattended in vehicles.
 - Report lost or stolen equipment to IT Security **immediately** (within one hour of discovering it, where possible) so that the device can be wiped or locked.
 - Return all Company property on request and at separation (see 9.4).
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1.9 Acceptable Use of Technology, Email, Internet and AI Tools

Purpose. To set out, from an HR perspective, the conduct expected when using Simtora's systems. Technical and security controls are covered in the IT Policy Manual (SIM-IT-001), which prevails on technical matters.

Scope. All employees, contractors and temporary staff using Simtora systems or personal devices that access Simtora data.

Authorization and accountability

- Use only systems and data you are authorized to access. Unauthorized access is prohibited and may be a crime under the Computer Fraud and Abuse Act and state law.
- Users are responsible for all activity under their accounts. Never share passwords or MFA codes.
- Accidental damage, disruption or suspected security incidents must be reported to IT Security immediately.

Internet use

Reasonable personal use is permitted in limited amounts when it does not interfere with work, degrade system performance or create risk. Users must not:

- Visit, download or share illegal, sexually explicit, hateful, violent or otherwise inappropriate material.
- Introduce malware, bypass security controls, or disable security software.
- Download or share copyrighted material or software without a valid license.
- Engage in hacking, unauthorized scanning, piracy, fraud or any illegal activity. (Authorized security testing is carried out only with written approval from IT Security.)
- Use Company systems for personal business ventures or financial gain.
- Post or transmit material that is harassing, defamatory, discriminatory or harmful to the Company's reputation.

Access to otherwise-restricted material needed for legitimate work (for example, security research) must be agreed with the manager and IT Security in advance.

Email and messaging (email, chat, video, collaboration tools)

- Company email and messaging tools are for business purposes; limited personal use is allowed as above.
- Messages must be professional. Do not send content that is bullying, harassing, discriminatory, defamatory, obscene or illegal; do not send chain letters or mass non-business messages.

- Email is not a secure channel. Do not send sensitive personal data, credentials, or customer secrets by email unless encrypted or approved by IT Security.
- Employees should treat Company messages as business records that may be retained, reviewed or produced in litigation.
- When out of the office for more than three working days, set an out-of-office reply naming an alternate contact, and arrange coverage for urgent items.
- Be cautious with attachments and links from unknown senders; report suspected phishing using the reporting tool.

Use of AI tools

- Employees may use AI tools (for example, code assistants and generative AI chat tools) that have been **approved by IT Security and Legal**. A current list is on the intranet.
- Do **not** enter customer data, personal data, credentials, source code marked confidential, or other non-public Simtora information into unapproved tools.
- AI output must be reviewed by a qualified person before use. The employee using the tool remains responsible for accuracy, licensing, security and bias of the output they use or deliver.
- Do not use AI tools to make or materially support decisions about hiring, promotion, pay, discipline or termination of any employee without HR and Legal approval and human review.

Personal devices (BYOD)

Personal phones or computers may access Company data only if enrolled in device management and meeting the IT Policy's security requirements. Simtora may remotely wipe Company data from enrolled devices; it does not access personal content.

Monitoring and privacy

- Company systems, accounts and devices, and all data on them, are Company property. To protect security, ensure compliance and investigate misconduct, Simtora may monitor, access, review, copy and retain activity and content on its systems, to the extent permitted by law, with or without advance notice, using authorized personnel only. **Employees should have no expectation of privacy in Company systems.**

- Where state law requires notice of electronic monitoring (for example, New York, Connecticut, Delaware), this section serves as that notice, and employees acknowledge it in Appendix A.
- Simtora will not monitor personal accounts or personal devices except as they interact with Company systems, and will not use monitoring to interfere with legally protected activity.

Consequences

Improper use may lead to restricted access, corrective action up to termination, and referral to law enforcement where the law has been broken.

Part 2 – Managing Performance

2.1 Performance Management

Purpose. To help every employee reach their potential, and align individual goals with company goals, through clear expectations, frequent feedback and fair evaluation.

Core principles

- Performance management is **continuous**, with formal checkpoints.
- Appraisal is a **two-way** conversation about the employee's achievements, needs and development and the Company's needs.
- Evaluation is fair, evidence-based and consistent, in line with the Equal Employment Opportunity policy.
- Results feed into development plans, pay and promotion decisions, and succession planning.

Process

Element	Frequency	Description
Goal setting	Annually (and at start of role)	Manager and employee agree on objectives and key results (OKRs) aligned to team and company goals, and a development plan.
One-on-ones	Weekly or bi-weekly	Short, regular conversations on priorities, feedback, blockers and wellbeing.
Mid-year check-in	Mid-year	Informal review of progress against goals; adjust goals if the business has changed.
Annual review	Annually (held in a designated window of about 4 weeks)	Formal review of the year's results and behaviors, with self-assessment, manager assessment, and peer input where appropriate.
Calibration	Annually	Managers and HR compare ratings across teams for consistency and fairness.

The annual review discussion

- Held in private; a time and place are communicated at least **one week** in advance. Review documents are shared with the employee before the meeting.
- The manager gives honest, constructive, timely feedback, recognizes achievement, and discusses development and career goals.
- The employee can add comments and disagree in writing. Both sign to confirm the discussion took place (signing does not mean agreement).
- Review content is confidential to the employee, manager, HR and relevant senior management.
- Reviewers must complete review training and be familiar with the employee's work.
- Employees who joined within 90 days of the review window are assessed on a pro-rata basis or through their probation review.

Development

Every review ends with an agreed **Personal Development Plan**, which HR uses to shape learning programs (see 7.1).

2.2 Attendance and Absence

Purpose. To ensure teams have the coverage and reliability they need, while supporting employees who are sick or need time away, and complying with law.

Expectations

- Employees are expected to be available during their scheduled working hours and, for hybrid and remote staff, core collaboration hours (see 5.1 and 5.2).
- Employees must give as much notice as possible of planned time off (see 6.2) and request approval in the HR system.
- **Unplanned absence** (illness, emergency): notify the manager **as early as possible and within one hour of your scheduled start**, by phone, text or messaging tool as the team specifies. If you cannot do so yourself, ask someone to do it for you. Keep your manager updated on expected return.
- Non-exempt employees record absences in the timekeeping system. Exempt employees record absences in the HR system.
- Personal appointments (medical, dental, other) should be scheduled outside core hours where practicable; notify your manager in advance.

Medical documentation

- For sick leave of **three or more consecutive working days**, the Company may ask for reasonable documentation from a health care provider, where permitted by law. Employees are not required to disclose diagnosis details.
- For leave under the FMLA, ADA or state/local leave laws, documentation follows those laws (see 6.4).
- Return-to-work clearance may be requested where permitted by law, for safety reasons.

Managing attendance concerns

- Managers discuss attendance problems informally first, and record the conversation.
- Absences protected by law (FMLA, ADA accommodation, military leave, state/local paid sick leave, workers' compensation, pregnancy-related or lactation leave) are **never** counted against an employee in attendance decisions.
- Where attendance issues persist, the corrective-action process applies (see 2.3).
- Two or more consecutive working days of no-call/no-show may be treated as job abandonment (see 9.3).

Sickness and long-term absence

- Managers consider each case individually and supportively. Employees are encouraged to tell their manager or HR early about any health issue that affects work so that support and accommodations can be put in place (see 4.1).
 - Long-term absence is managed through HR in line with FMLA, the ADA and state law. Simtora may fill a role on a temporary or permanent basis where business needs require, as permitted by law, and subject to reinstatement rights under applicable leave laws.
-

2.3 Corrective Action (Disciplinary Procedure)

Purpose. To provide a fair, consistent and lawful way of addressing misconduct or performance that falls short of expectations. The aim is to correct and improve, not to punish, but sanctions may be necessary.

Scope. All employees. Introductory-period employees are covered, though the procedure may be shortened.

Principles

- Used when informal coaching has not worked or the matter is serious enough to require formal steps.
- **At-will:** Simtora is not required to follow the steps below in order, and may skip steps or end employment at any time, consistent with at-will employment and the law. The steps describe typical practice, not a promise.

- Every case is investigated promptly and fairly before action is taken. The employee has a chance to explain.
- Similar cases are treated consistently. Action must not be taken because of a protected characteristic or protected activity.
- Decisions are documented, and HR reviews all formal actions before they are issued.
- Employees may bring concerns about a corrective action to HR under 3.1.

Steps (typical)

Step	When used	What happens
1. Coaching / counseling	Minor issues, first occurrence	Informal, documented conversation: what is expected, timeline to improve, when it will be reviewed, and that failure to improve may lead to formal action.
2. Verbal warning	Minor misconduct or continuing performance issue	Manager states the concern and required improvement; a short file note is kept.
3. Written warning	Verbal warning not heeded; repeat or more serious issue	Written notice signed by the manager and HR, with the facts, required improvement, timeline and consequences. The employee may add comments.
4. Final written warning	Serious issue just short of termination, or continued failure after a written warning	As above; warns that further issues may result in termination.
5. Termination	Gross misconduct, or continued issues after the steps above	Decided by the Department Head with HR (and Legal where appropriate). See 9.2.

Other outcomes may include: demotion or transfer (as a last step before termination where the employee is unsuited to the role but dismissal is not warranted), loss of bonus or equity eligibility where plan terms allow, or required training.

Examples of conduct that may lead to corrective action

(Not exhaustive.)

Examples of minor misconduct:

- Repeated lateness or unreliable availability.
- Unexplained or unreported absence.
- Failure to follow prescribed procedures, including code review, change management or security procedures.
- Missing deadlines or repeated quality problems.
- Breach of dress code, or other minor breaches of policy.

Examples of gross misconduct (may warrant immediate suspension and termination):

- Theft, fraud or dishonesty, including falsifying timesheets, expense claims or records.
- Serious breach of confidentiality, data protection or security, including deliberate data exfiltration, sharing credentials, or intentionally circumventing security controls.
- Violence, threats, intimidation or bullying.
- Discrimination, harassment (including sexual harassment) or retaliation.
- Being unfit for duty due to alcohol or drugs (see 4.2).
- Serious or repeated insubordination, or refusal of a lawful instruction.
- Bribery, corruption, serious conflict of interest, or undisclosed outside work that competes with Simtora.
- Willful damage to property or systems; unauthorized access to systems or data.
- Falsifying qualifications, credentials or application information.
- Serious breach of the law or these policies that damages or could damage the Company.

Suspension

- Suspension (with pay) is **not** a disciplinary sanction. It may be used to protect people or evidence, or allow an investigation to proceed.
- Only the Department Head, together with HR, can authorize a suspension. The employee is told in writing of the reason, start date and time, and expected timescale, and is asked to keep the matter confidential and to cooperate.

- Suspension is reviewed by HR at least every **5 business days** and ends as soon as practicable.

Investigation

- HR (or an impartial investigator) gathers evidence and interviews relevant people, treating the matter confidentially to the extent possible.
- The employee is told of the allegation and given an opportunity to respond before a decision is made.
- Retaliation against anyone who participates in good faith in an investigation is prohibited.

Appeal

- An employee can ask HR to review a written warning or termination decision within **5 business days** of receiving it, by writing to HR and stating their grounds. A senior leader not involved in the original decision reviews and responds within 10 business days. That decision is final.

2.4 Performance Improvement Plans (Capability Procedure)

Purpose. To provide a fair and objective process for addressing performance that doesn't meet expected standards, and to give the employee a real chance to improve, through clear expectations and support.

Policy

- Performance concerns should be raised early in one-on-ones. Where they persist, the manager, with HR, may put the employee on a **Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)**.
- The PIP is a written plan that includes:
 1. The specific areas of concern, with examples and evidence.
 2. The standard required, with measurable goals.
 3. The support the Company will provide (coaching, training, tools, reduced distractions).

4. The review dates (typically every 2 weeks) and overall duration (usually **30–60 days**).
 5. The possible outcomes, including that failure to improve may result in termination.
- The employee can respond in writing and raise any factors that affect performance, such as health, workload or accommodation needs. HR considers whether accommodation or leave rights are relevant before proceeding.
 - Outcomes are: (a) **successful completion**: the PIP ends and normal management resumes; (b) **extension** for a short period where good progress has been made; (c) **further action**, which may include demotion, transfer or termination.
 - Where the PIP arises from misconduct rather than capability, the corrective-action procedure (2.3) applies.
 - A PIP is not a prerequisite to termination. Simtora may end at-will employment without one (for example, in a role elimination or serious performance failure).
-

Part 3 – Dealing with Employee Concerns

3.1 Open Door and Grievance Procedure

Purpose. To give every employee a fair and confidential way to raise concerns about their working conditions or treatment and to have them resolved quickly.

Scope. Any work-related concern. It does not replace the complaint routes in 3.2 (harassment, discrimination) or 3.3 (whistleblowing), or any external legal rights, and employees are never required to use it before contacting a government agency.

Open door

Employees are encouraged to raise concerns with their manager, any other manager, or HR at any time. Simtora will listen, take concerns seriously, and will not retaliate against anyone who raises a concern in good faith.

Steps

Stage	What happens	Typical timescale
1. Informal	Raise the concern with your manager (or their manager if the concern is about your manager), verbally or in writing. Many issues are best solved here.	Response within 5 business days
2. Formal	If unresolved, submit a written grievance to HR stating the issue and what outcome you seek. HR acknowledges it within 2 business days, investigates where needed, meets with you, and issues a written response.	Response within 15 business days of receipt
3. Appeal	If still dissatisfied, you may appeal in writing within 5 business days to the Chief People Officer (or the CEO where the concern relates to the Chief People Officer or a member of the Executive Team). The decision at this stage is final.	Decision within 15 business days

Timescales can be extended by agreement or where an investigation requires it, and the employee is kept informed.

Mediation

Where appropriate, and if all parties agree, Simtora may offer **mediation** using a trained internal or external mediator. Mediation is voluntary and confidential; the mediator helps the parties reach their own agreement and does not decide who is right. It may be used at any stage, including to rebuild working relationships afterwards, and formal processes may be paused while it takes place.

Support

Employees may bring a colleague to a grievance meeting for support (not as legal representative), unless the law provides otherwise. (Where employees have rights to representation under the National Labor Relations Act, Simtora will respect them.)

3.2 Anti-Harassment, Anti-Discrimination and Anti-Retaliation

Purpose. To ensure every person at Simtora is treated with dignity and respect, in a workplace free of harassment, discrimination, bullying and retaliation.

Scope. All employees, applicants, interns, contractors, consultants, vendors, customers and visitors, at every work location and remote setting, at Company events, on business travel, and online (including chat, video, social media and other electronic communications) and outside working hours where conduct affects the workplace.

Policy statement

Simtora has **zero tolerance** for harassment, discrimination, bullying or retaliation. We will investigate every report promptly, fairly and as confidentially as possible, and take appropriate action, regardless of whether the report is formal or informal.

What is prohibited

Discrimination and harassment based on a protected characteristic — including race, color, religion or creed, sex (including pregnancy, childbirth, lactation and related conditions), gender, gender identity or expression, sexual orientation, national origin, ancestry, citizenship or immigration status, age (40+), physical or mental disability, genetic information, military or veteran status, marital or family status, caregiver status, or any other characteristic protected by federal, state or local law.

Sexual harassment is unwelcome conduct of a sexual nature. It includes:

- Unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, or pressure for dates or sex.
- Conditioning job benefits (hiring, pay, promotion, continued employment) on sexual conduct (*quid pro quo*).
- A hostile environment created by sexual or gender-based jokes, comments, images, messages, gestures, touching or exclusion.
- Comments on someone's body or sex life; sharing sexual content through any channel, including chat and video calls.

- Conduct in virtual settings: inappropriate behavior on video calls, unwanted direct messages, or contact outside work hours through personal channels.

Other harassment covers unwelcome conduct related to any protected characteristic that is severe or pervasive or otherwise unlawful under applicable state law, and which would create an intimidating, hostile or offensive environment. Simtora's standard is stricter than the legal minimum: conduct may violate this policy even if it is not unlawful.

Bullying is repeated, unreasonable behavior directed at a person or group that creates a risk to their health, safety or wellbeing, or an intimidating environment. Examples: shouting or aggression; public humiliation; persistent undermining; singling out an individual; setting unrealistic targets or deadlines as a form of punishment; spreading rumors; deliberate exclusion; "cyberbullying" by email, chat or social media. Reasonable management action carried out in a reasonable way is not bullying.

Retaliation against anyone who reports a concern in good faith, participates in an investigation, requests an accommodation or leave, or otherwise engages in legally protected activity is strictly prohibited and is itself grounds for corrective action, up to termination.

How to report

Anyone who experiences or witnesses conduct that may violate this policy is encouraged to report it **promptly**. Employees may use any of these routes:

- Their manager, or any manager or HR representative (they do not have to go through their own manager).
- HR directly: hr@simtora.example.
- The confidential Ethics Line (anonymous reports accepted): ethics@simtora.example.

Manager responsibilities

- Any manager who sees, hears or is told about possible harassment, discrimination or retaliation **must report it to HR the same day**, even if the employee asks them not to or says it is informal.
- Managers must not investigate on their own, promise confidentiality they can't keep, or take retaliatory action.
- Failing to report or acting on a complaint is itself a breach of policy.

Investigation and outcome

1. HR acknowledges the report within **2 business days**, discusses options and interim measures (for example, schedule or reporting-line changes, or temporary adjustments to reduce contact) with the complainant.
2. HR, or an impartial external investigator where appropriate, investigates promptly, interviewing the complainant, respondent and witnesses and reviewing evidence. The goal is to conclude within 30 days of the report, with updates to the parties as appropriate.
3. The decision-maker determines whether the policy was breached, and what corrective action is needed. Both parties are informed of the outcome to the extent appropriate and lawful.
4. If one party needs to be moved, the Company will normally move the person who is the subject of the complaint, rather than the complainant. A move is not a finding of fault and is not a detriment to either.
5. Reports and investigations are handled confidentially to the extent possible, and on a need-to-know basis. Breaching confidentiality may lead to corrective action. (Employees' rights to discuss their own complaints and working conditions are not limited.)
6. **Malicious or knowingly false** reports, made in bad faith, may lead to corrective action. A report made in good faith but not substantiated will not.

Training

All employees complete anti-harassment training within **30 days** of hire and annually thereafter. Managers complete additional training on their duties. Simtora complies with state-mandated training requirements.

External remedies

Employees may also contact the **U.S. Equal Employment Opportunity Commission (EEOC)** (1-800-669-4000, www.eeoc.gov) or the state or local fair employment agency, which set time limits for filing. Using the internal process does not extend those limits, and no one is required to use the internal process first.

3.3 Whistleblower Policy

Purpose. To encourage and protect anyone who, in good faith, reports suspected wrongdoing so problems are found and fixed early and Simtora maintains the highest standards of integrity, openness and accountability.

Scope. All employees, contractors, consultants, interns, vendors and other stakeholders.

Matters covered

Concerns about actual or suspected:

- Fraud, financial misstatement, or accounting, internal-control or audit irregularities.
- Bribery, corruption, kickbacks, or violation of law or regulation.
- Theft or misuse of Company funds, assets, or information.
- Data privacy or security breaches, or concealment of them.
- Conflicts of interest or procurement irregularities.
- Discrimination, harassment or retaliation (which may also be raised under 3.2).
- Health, safety or environmental dangers.
- Manipulation or falsification of Company records or data.
- Abuse of authority, or attempts to conceal any of the above.

This policy is not for personal grievances about one's own terms of employment (use 3.1), though employees may raise them under either policy.

How to report

- To a manager, HR, Legal or the Chief People Officer.
- Through the **Ethics Line** (anonymous reports accepted): ethics@simtora.example.
- To the **Audit Committee of the Board** for concerns about accounting, audit, or senior management: audit@simtora.example.
- To any **government agency** at any time. No permission or notice to Simtora is required (see 1.8).

Reports should include as much detail as possible: what, who, when, where and any evidence. Reporters are not expected to prove wrongdoing or investigate themselves.

Protection

- Reports made in **good faith** and on reasonable belief are protected. No one will be dismissed, demoted, suspended, threatened, harassed or otherwise disadvantaged for making one, or for assisting an investigation. Retaliation is serious misconduct and may itself be unlawful (for example, under the Sarbanes-Oxley Act, Dodd-Frank Act and state whistleblower statutes).
- The reporter's identity is kept confidential to the extent possible, consistent with a fair investigation and the law. Anonymous reports are accepted and considered on the seriousness, credibility and verifiability of the claim.
- An employee who reports a matter they were themselves involved in is not exempt from corrective action, but self-reporting is taken into account.

Handling

1. Reports go to the Chief People Officer or General Counsel (or the Audit Committee chair for financial or senior-management matters), who log and review them.
2. Acknowledgement within **5 business days** where the reporter is known.
3. A proportionate investigation is carried out by an independent person; findings and actions are reported to the Audit Committee.
4. The reporter is told the matter was addressed to the extent possible, although details may be limited by confidentiality and privacy.

Untrue allegations

No action is taken against anyone who makes an allegation in good faith that is not confirmed. **Knowingly false or malicious** allegations may lead to corrective action.

Part 4 – Supporting Our People in the Workplace

4.1 Equal Employment Opportunity and Reasonable Accommodation

Purpose. To give everyone a fair chance to be hired, to progress and to succeed on the basis of ability, and to provide reasonable accommodations as required by law.

Scope. All applicants and employees, and all employment practices: recruiting, hiring, job assignment, pay, benefits, promotion, transfer, training, discipline, termination and everything in between.

Policy statement

Simtora is an **equal opportunity employer**. We do not discriminate, and do not tolerate discrimination or victimization, on the basis of race, color, religion, sex (including pregnancy and related conditions), gender identity or expression, sexual orientation, national origin, age, disability, genetic information, military or veteran status, marital or family status, or any other characteristic protected by federal, state or local law. We value diversity and aim for a workforce that reflects the communities we serve, and a culture in which everyone feels respected and able to do their best work.

Our commitments

- Decisions are based on merit, skill, performance and business needs.
- Recruitment, pay, promotion and development processes are regularly reviewed for bias and unjustified impact, and corrected.
- Every employee is entitled to a workplace that promotes dignity and respect.
- Training, development and progression are open to all.
- Breaches of this policy are misconduct and may lead to corrective action up to termination.
- This policy is monitored and reviewed annually under the supervision of the CEO, with results summarized to the Executive Team.

Responsibilities

- **Employees:** comply, treat all colleagues and customers with respect and without regard to irrelevant characteristics, tell HR or their manager if they see a possible

breach.

- **Managers:** apply EEO principles in every decision about hiring, assignment, pay, promotion and development; provide reasonable accommodations; make sure their team understands the policy.

Reasonable accommodation (ADA, PWFA and religious)

Simtora provides **reasonable accommodations** to qualified individuals with disabilities, for known limitations related to pregnancy, childbirth or related conditions, for sincerely held religious beliefs and practices, and for lactation (break time and a private space that is not a bathroom), unless doing so would cause undue hardship.

Process:

1. The employee (or their representative) tells their manager or HR that they need a change at work for a reason covered above. No special words or written form are needed.
2. HR starts an **interactive process** promptly: a confidential discussion about the limitation, the job's needs and possible solutions, with medical documentation requested only where needed and permitted.
3. HR decides, in consultation with the manager, what accommodation is effective and reasonable. The employee may propose options.
4. Decisions are documented and reviewed periodically.

Examples of accommodation: adjusted schedule or remote work, assistive technology, ergonomic equipment, modified duties, leave, reassignment to a vacant role, schedule changes for religious observance, and adjusted training or assessment formats.

Medical information is kept confidential in a file separate from the personnel file and shared only as the law permits.

Remedies

Employees who believe they have been discriminated against should use 3.1 or 3.2 or contact the EEOC or state agency. Retaliation is prohibited.

4.2 Drug- and Alcohol-Free Workplace

Purpose. To keep the workplace safe, healthy and productive, and to support employees with substance-use problems.

Policy

- Employees must not work, or attend Company-related events or other business activity, **under the influence of alcohol, illegal drugs, or misused prescription or other controlled substances** to an extent that impairs judgment, safety or performance.
- The unlawful manufacture, distribution, possession, sale or use of illegal drugs on Company premises, in Company vehicles, or while on Company business is **prohibited and may result in immediate termination**. Simtora complies with the federal Drug-Free Workplace Act where it applies.
- **Alcohol** may be served or consumed only at Company-approved events, with management approval, in moderation, with non-alcoholic options and safe-transport arrangements; attendance is always optional, and employees remain subject to conduct policies.
- **Cannabis.** Even where use is lawful under state law, employees may not use cannabis on Company premises or while working, or be impaired at work. Simtora follows state laws that restrict adverse action based on lawful off-duty use, and any accommodation for medical use, as they apply.
- **Prescription medication.** Employees taking legally prescribed medication that may affect safety or performance are encouraged to talk confidentially with HR about whether any adjustment is needed. They are not required to disclose the medical condition.
- **Testing.** Simtora does not routinely test employees. Drug or alcohol testing may be carried out only where permitted by applicable law, such as where there is reasonable suspicion of impairment, after a workplace accident, or where required by a customer contract or law for a specific role. Any such testing follows state law requirements and is carried out confidentially.

Support

Employees who believe they have an alcohol or drug problem are encouraged to seek help early. Simtora will treat requests for help confidentially, consider leave or accommodation as required by law (for example, FMLA or ADA for treatment of a covered condition), and offer access to the Employee Assistance Program (see 4.4). Seeking help before a performance or conduct issue arises will not itself lead to corrective action, but it does not excuse violations of this policy.

4.3 Health, Safety and Workplace Violence Prevention

Purpose. To provide a safe and healthy workplace for employees, visitors and contractors, in offices and in remote and hybrid settings, in compliance with the Occupational Safety and Health Act (OSHA) and state law.

General policy

Simtora accepts its obligations under federal, state and local health and safety law. Consideration of the health, safety and wellbeing of staff is an integral part of management. The Head of Facilities (with the Chief People Officer) is responsible for the program and reports to the Executive Team.

Shared responsibility

- **Simtora** provides a safe workplace, training, equipment and emergency procedures, and investigates incidents.
- **Employees** must take reasonable care of their own safety and that of others, follow safety rules, and cooperate with the Company. **Employees have the right to raise safety concerns, and to report injuries and hazards, without retaliation.** They may also contact OSHA.
- **Managers** must ensure their teams follow safe practices and act on any hazard reported.
- Refusal to follow safety rules may lead to corrective action; repeated or serious cases can lead to termination.

Key provisions

- **Emergency preparedness:** Each office has a posted emergency plan (fire, weather, medical, security), trained fire wardens and first aiders, marked exits, regularly tested alarms, and drills at least annually. Employees must know the plan for their work area. Remote employees should know local emergency numbers and keep their address current in the HR system.
- **Incident reporting:** Any workplace injury, illness, near miss or hazard must be reported to the manager and HR **the same day**. HR completes an incident report, and records and reports to OSHA as required. Employees injured at work are covered by workers' compensation; Simtora will help with claims and will not retaliate.
- **First aid:** First-aid kits and AEDs are provided in offices; trained first-aiders are identified.
- **Ergonomics and display screen equipment:** Workstations (office and home) should follow ergonomic guidance. HR provides an ergonomic self-assessment at onboarding and on request, and equipment to address identified risks (see 7.4). Take regular breaks from screens.
- **Hazardous substances and equipment:** Managers must have new equipment and any hazardous materials (for example, batteries, cleaning products, server-room gas suppression) checked by Facilities before use.
- **Lifting and handling:** Use safe lifting techniques; use carts or ask for help with heavy items such as hardware.
- **Smoke- and vape-free:** Smoking and vaping are not permitted inside Company buildings, vehicles, or within 25 feet of entrances, and at all Company events, except in designated outdoor areas.
- **Contractors and visitors:** Contractors, agency staff and visitors on Company premises must follow Simtora's safety rules and sign in. Employees who see unsafe behavior or risk should tell their manager or Facilities immediately.
- **Security:** Follow building-access rules and visitor procedures; do not tailgate; challenge politely or report unescorted strangers.
- **Infectious illness:** Employees with contagious illness should stay home and use sick leave. Simtora follows public-health guidance and may introduce temporary measures.

Workplace violence

- Simtora prohibits violence, threats, stalking, intimidation, and possession of weapons on Company premises or at Company events, to the extent permitted by state law.

- Report any threat or violent incident to Facilities/Security and HR immediately; in an emergency call **911** first.
- Simtora will investigate, take protective action, and, where appropriate, involve law enforcement. Employees affected by domestic violence, stalking or harassment that may spill into the workplace can talk confidentially to HR about safety planning and leave or accommodation (some states provide specific leave).

Remote and hybrid safety

Remote employees are responsible for maintaining a reasonably safe home workspace, and Simtora's responsibility extends to work-related injury in the home workspace, which must be reported as above. Simtora does not inspect home offices without the employee's agreement.

Working time

Simtora is committed to lawful working time. Normal hours are in 5.1. Employees are expected to take their meal and rest breaks as required by state law and to take regular time away from work, including their PTO. Managers must not pressure employees to work unrecorded or excessive hours.

4.4 Employee Wellbeing

- **Employee Assistance Program (EAP):** confidential counseling, legal and financial consultations and work-life support for employees and household members, at no cost, 24/7. Details: benefits portal.
 - **Mental health support:** mental-health days are part of PTO and sick leave, and managers are encouraged to support their use. Managers should respond to signs of stress by checking in and, where appropriate, involving HR.
 - **Wellbeing resources:** wellness stipend, fitness or mindfulness offerings, and learning sessions on wellbeing, described in the benefits guide.
 - **Workload and burnout:** Managers monitor workload, protect time away from work, and do not expect responses outside working hours except for agreed on-call duties (see 5.3).
-

Part 5 – Ways of Working

5.1 Working Hours and Timekeeping

Purpose. To provide clarity and flexibility on when work is done, while meeting business needs and wage-and-hour law.

Scope. All employees. Teams with specific coverage needs (such as Support and Operations) set schedules in line with this policy.

Standard schedule

Item	Standard
Work week	Monday–Friday
Standard hours	8 hours per day, 40 per week
Core collaboration hours	10:00 am – 3:00 pm in the employee's local time zone (or team-defined overlap for distributed teams)
Meal break	Unpaid meal period of at least 30 minutes (longer where state law requires); non-exempt employees are fully relieved of duty
Rest breaks	As required by state law (paid, for non-exempt)

Flexibility

- Within the core hours, employees can shape their day with their manager's agreement: for example, starting earlier or later, or splitting the day for personal commitments, provided they complete their hours (non-exempt) or meet their commitments and stay reachable (exempt).
- Teams agree on availability norms (response times, meeting windows, handoffs) and document them.
- Hours may be changed to meet business needs; employees get reasonable notice.
- Meetings should be scheduled within core hours, with time-zone fairness.

Timekeeping

- **Non-exempt employees** must accurately record all time worked, including start and stop times and meal periods, in the timekeeping system, and approve the timesheet each pay period. Falsifying time records is gross misconduct. Managers must not edit time without the employee's knowledge.
- **Exempt employees** do not record hours but are expected to work the hours needed to do the job, and to record absences. Exempt status does not remove the right to take PTO or to have a reasonable work-life balance.
- Report missed punches and errors to your manager or payroll **the same day**.

Overtime and extra hours

See 1.5. All overtime requires manager pre-approval, and all hours worked are paid.

Working time limits

Employees and managers must comply with any state or local restrictions on hours, rest periods and scheduling (including predictive scheduling laws for any shift-based roles).

5.2 Hybrid and Remote Work

Purpose. To set a clear, fair framework for where work is done, supporting collaboration, productivity, wellbeing and security.

Scope. All employees whose roles can be performed partly or fully away from a Simtora office. Roles that require on-site presence (for example, lab, hardware or facilities roles) are designated in their job descriptions.

Work models

Model	Description
Hybrid (default)	Work from a Simtora office on anchor days (Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday) , or a minimum of 3 days per week , and from home or another approved location on other days.
Fully remote	Approved for specific roles and individuals where business need and location allow. Attends quarterly team gatherings and company events, with travel paid by Simtora.
On-site	Roles that require regular on-site presence, as stated in the job description.

Work model is set in the offer letter and reviewed by HR and the Department Head when the role changes.

Expectations

- **Availability:** Be available and responsive during core hours, and as agreed with the team. Keep calendar, status and contact details up to date.
- **Productivity:** Output, quality and collaboration are the measures — not visibility. Remote and hybrid employees are held to the same standards and have the same opportunities for development and promotion.
- **Workspace:** Maintain a safe, private, reasonably quiet workspace with reliable internet for work and video calls. Simtora provides equipment and a stipend (see 7.4).
- **Security:** Follow the IT Policy: use Company devices, VPN and MFA, lock screens, keep work data off personal storage, avoid shoulder-surfing and overheard conversations, and do not work with confidential information on public Wi-Fi without the VPN.
- **Not a substitute for care:** Remote work is not a replacement for childcare or caring for dependents during working hours, though flexible scheduling can help (see 5.1).
- **Meetings:** In hybrid meetings, be inclusive of remote participants (cameras on where practical, shared documents, written notes).

Location rules

- Employees must work from their **registered home state** (and the U.S.). Working from a different state or country for more than **10 working days in a calendar year**, or permanently relocating, needs prior written approval from HR. Different locations can

create tax, payroll, employment-law, benefits and security consequences for the employee and Simtora, and approval may be refused or conditioned.

- Working outside the U.S. is permitted only with advance written approval from HR, Legal, Security and Finance, and only for approved periods.
- Employees must update their address in the HR system within 10 days of any move.

Commuting and expenses

Commuting to a Simtora office is not reimbursable. Reasonable work-related travel away from the usual location follows 8.1. Employees in states with expense-reimbursement requirements for remote work (for example, California) will be reimbursed as the law requires through the stipend in 7.4 and expense process in 1.6.

Flexibility and review

- Managers may approve occasional exceptions (such as a one-off day remote or in-office) for personal circumstances.
- The Company may change the model, anchor days or location requirements with reasonable notice, for business reasons.
- Work-from-home arrangements made as a disability accommodation follow 4.1 and are not affected by this policy.
- Remote work privileges can be changed or withdrawn for performance, conduct, security or business reasons.

5.3 On-Call and After-Hours Support

Purpose. To ensure the reliability of Simtora's services while treating on-call work fairly and sustainably.

Scope. Teams that support production systems and customers outside normal hours (for example, Site Reliability, Engineering, Support and Security).

Policy

- On-call is by **rotation**, scheduled in advance (at least 2 weeks' notice where practicable), and shared fairly across eligible team members. No one should be on call

more than **one week in four** without their consent.

- On-call duties, response expectations (for example, acknowledge within 15 minutes) and escalation paths are documented by each team.
 - **Compensation:**
 - Employees on call receive an **on-call stipend** per week of rotation, set by the Compensation Committee and published on the intranet.
 - **Non-exempt** employees are paid for all time actually worked when called out (including remote troubleshooting), with minimum call-out pay where state law requires, and overtime where applicable. Where the on-call restrictions are so severe that the time is itself working time under the FLSA, it is paid as such.
 - **Exempt** employees receive the stipend and, following a significant overnight incident, are encouraged to take recovery time (for example, a late start or time off in lieu) with manager agreement.
 - **Rest:** Employees should have at least **11 hours** of rest between finishing an out-of-hours incident and resuming normal work, where feasible, with schedules adjusted by the manager.
 - **Wellbeing:** Managers review on-call load, incident volume and burnout signs, and act to reduce alert noise and fix root causes. Employees can request to be removed from rotation for health, caregiving or other valid reasons, and HR will consider accommodation needs.
 - On-call staff are provided the equipment and connectivity required (see 7.4).
-

5.4 Dress Code

Purpose. To set a simple standard of presentation that supports our professional image while allowing individual expression, comfort and inclusion.

Scope. All employees, at Simtora offices, at customer sites, and at Company events. (Remote employees should follow it for video calls with customers or partners.)

Policy

- **Office and everyday work: business casual or smart casual** dress that is clean, neat and appropriate for the day's activities. There is no required uniform or gendered

standard.

- **Customer meetings, events and external representation:** dress to the expectations of the audience; if unsure, ask your manager (business attire where appropriate).
 - **Generally not appropriate:** clothing with offensive, discriminatory, or explicit words or images; clothing that is sexually revealing or overly torn; and footwear that is unsafe in the work environment (such as when visiting a lab or data center).
 - **Personal hygiene:** everyone is expected to maintain good personal hygiene, with consideration for shared spaces.
 - **Safety:** Employees working with equipment or in designated areas (for example, labs, data centers or warehouses) must wear the PPE and clothing the area requires.
 - **Flexibility and inclusion:** Simtora provides exceptions and adjustments for religious dress and grooming (for example, head coverings, hairstyles, facial hair), disability, pregnancy, medical needs, and gender identity and expression, consistent with 4.1. Employees can dress and present consistent with their gender identity.
 - Managers may privately ask an employee to adjust their attire if it doesn't meet these standards, and should do so respectfully and consistently. Concerns go to HR.
-

5.5 Personal Relationships and Employment of Relatives

Purpose. To avoid conflicts of interest, favoritism or the appearance of it, while welcoming applications from people connected to our employees.

Definitions

- A **relative** is a spouse or domestic partner, parent, child, sibling, grandparent, grandchild, aunt, uncle, cousin, niece or nephew, in-law, step-relative, or anyone else in a similar close relationship, including household members.
- A **close personal relationship** includes romantic or intimate relationships and close friendships or business relationships that could affect objectivity.

Policy

Employment of relatives

- Simtora welcomes applications from relatives of employees. They are considered on merit using the normal process, and the related employee has no involvement in the decision.
- A relative may not be hired into, or transferred into, a role where they would **directly or indirectly report to, supervise, or have influence over the pay, reviews, hiring, promotion or discipline** of a relative, or where the relationship would create a conflict of interest, security or control risk (for example, both approving each other's expenses, or one having oversight of the other's system access).
- Where a relationship forms (for example by marriage) and would create such a situation, the employees must tell HR **promptly**. The parties may decide between them which will move; if they have not decided within **30 calendar days**, management will decide. Where no other arrangement is possible, Simtora may end the employment of one of them as a last resort.

Romantic and close personal relationships

- Romantic or sexual relationships between a manager and anyone in their reporting chain, or where one person has influence over the other's employment, are prohibited unless disclosed so that the reporting relationship can be changed. The **more senior person** has the duty to disclose to HR promptly.
- Employees in other relationships at work are expected to behave professionally and not let them disrupt work or cause conflicts of interest.
- Consensual relationships do not change the rules on harassment; unwelcome conduct is still prohibited (see 3.2).
- HR handles disclosures confidentially. Failing to disclose may lead to corrective action.

Part 6 – Leave and Benefits

How these fit together. State and local laws may give you more than what's shown here (for example, paid sick leave or paid family leave laws). Simtora always follows the more generous standard. See Appendix D for a summary table.

6.1 Paid Holidays

- **Leave year:** January 1 – December 31.
- Simtora observes **11 paid holidays** per year for regular full-time employees: New Year's Day, Martin Luther King Jr. Day, Presidents' Day, Memorial Day, Juneteenth, Independence Day, Labor Day, Thanksgiving Day, the day after Thanksgiving, Christmas Eve (or Christmas Day if the day falls otherwise) and Christmas Day, with a **winter shutdown** between December 26 and December 31 using PTO or Company-designated days where announced.
- **2 floating holidays** per year are available to use for cultural, religious or personal observances, scheduled with the manager, pro-rated for part-time employees and for those who join mid-year. They do not carry over.
- The holiday calendar is published on **January 1** each year. Where a holiday falls on a weekend, the observed day is shown on the calendar.
- Holiday pay is at base pay for the usual hours for regular employees. Non-exempt employees who are required to work on a Company holiday receive their normal pay plus time-and-a-half for hours worked (or an alternative day off, as stated in the schedule) — subject to manager approval and state law.
- A holiday during PTO is not counted as a PTO day.

6.2 Paid Time Off (PTO)

Purpose. To encourage employees to take time to rest and recharge, which supports wellbeing and productivity.

Scope. Regular full-time employees accrue PTO; regular part-time employees accrue pro-rata. Interns and temporary employees accrue as stated in their terms.

Accrual (per year, accrued each pay period)

Years of service	PTO days per year
Less than 3 years	15 days
3 to 5 years	20 days
6 or more years	25 days

- PTO accrues from the start date, and is available to use after 30 days of employment (see 1.4). Part-time employees accrue in proportion to their hours.
- PTO is taken in hours or days and includes vacation, personal days and mental-health days. It is **separate** from sick and safe leave (6.3) and paid holidays (6.1).
- **Carry-over and cap:** up to **5 days** of unused PTO may carry over into the next year; unused days above that are forfeited at year end, **except where state law prohibits forfeiture** (for example, California), in which case Simtora applies accrual caps of 1.5 times the annual accrual instead. PTO stops accruing when the cap is reached.
- **Pay on separation:** Unused accrued PTO is paid out at separation **if required by state law** (for example, in California, Colorado, Illinois and some other states). Otherwise, it is not paid out.
- Simtora encourages employees to use at least **10 consecutive working days** of time off (at one time or in two blocks) each year.

Requesting and approving

- Request PTO in the HR system. Give notice roughly **double the length of the absence** (e.g., 2 weeks' notice for 1 week) wherever possible.
- Managers decide on requests within **3 business days**, considering business needs, project deadlines and fairness across the team, and will not unreasonably refuse. Where two requests conflict, earlier requests generally take priority.
- Managers must not contact employees on PTO except in a real emergency.
- Employees should check their balance before requesting. **PTO may not be taken in advance of accrual** without the written approval of the manager and HR.
- Time off without approval (other than protected leave) is unapproved absence and may lead to corrective action.
- Paid PTO is paid at the employee's base rate; it does not include overtime or special pay.

6.3 Sick and Safe Leave

- Regular employees receive **8 days (64 hours) of paid sick and safe leave per year**, available from their first day (or as state or local law provides if earlier or longer). The amount is pro-rated for part-time employees.

- In jurisdictions with paid sick leave laws that provide more (in accrual, carry-over, usage or scope), Simtora follows the law, which may allow use for additional reasons, and will provide any required notices.
 - **Permitted uses:** the employee's own illness, injury, medical or mental-health care, preventive care; care of a family member (as defined by law); and absences related to domestic violence, sexual assault or stalking (safe leave); and public-health closures, where state law provides.
 - **Notice:** for foreseeable needs (such as appointments), give as much notice as practicable; for unforeseeable needs, notify as soon as practicable and within one hour of the start of the shift where possible (see 2.2).
 - **Documentation** may be requested only as the law allows (generally for absences of three or more consecutive days).
 - Unused sick leave carries over **up to 40 hours** (more where required by law). It is not paid out on separation, unless state law requires.
 - Sick leave used for protected reasons is never counted against the employee in attendance or review decisions.
-

6.4 Family and Medical Leave (FMLA)

Simtora is covered by the **Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA)**.

- **Eligibility:** employees who have worked for Simtora for at least **12 months** (need not be consecutive), have worked at least **1,250 hours** in the previous 12 months, and work at a site with 50 or more employees within 75 miles.
- **Entitlement:** up to **12 workweeks** of **unpaid**, job-protected leave in a 12-month period (the rolling 12 months measured backward from the date leave is used) for: the birth of a child and bonding; adoption or foster placement; the employee's own serious health condition; care for a spouse, child or parent with a serious health condition; or a qualifying exigency for a military family member. Up to **26 workweeks** in a single 12-month period for care of a covered servicemember with a serious injury or illness.
- **Pay and benefits:** FMLA leave is unpaid, but employees may (or where required, must) use accrued paid leave concurrently, and Simtora may run company paid leave (for example, parental leave, 6.5) concurrently. **Group health benefits continue** on the

same terms as if the employee were working; the employee continues to pay their share.

- **Notice:** 30 days' advance notice where the need is foreseeable, and otherwise as soon as practicable. HR provides eligibility and designation notices within 5 business days of learning of the need.
 - **Certification:** a health care provider's certification may be requested for serious health conditions. Medical information is kept confidential.
 - **Reinstatement:** on return, employees are restored to the same or an equivalent position with equivalent pay, benefits and terms, subject to the law's limited exceptions.
 - **Non-interference and no retaliation:** Simtora will not interfere with, or retaliate for, use of FMLA leave.
 - **State laws:** State family and medical leave and paid family leave programs (for example, California, New York, New Jersey, Washington, Massachusetts, Colorado and others) may apply in addition to or instead of FMLA; HR will coordinate these and explain the options.
 - Employees can contact HR for forms and procedures.
-

6.5 Parental Leave

- **Eligibility:** regular employees with **at least 6 months** of service at the date of birth, adoption or foster placement (this service requirement is waived where state law requires).
- **Paid parental leave:**
 - **Primary caregiver:** up to **12 weeks** of paid leave at 100% of base pay.
 - **Secondary caregiver:** up to **6 weeks** of paid leave at 100% of base pay.
 - Applies to birth (including surrogacy), adoption and foster placement, for all genders and family types. If both parents work at Simtora, each may take leave in their own category.
- Leave must be taken within **12 months** of birth or placement, in a single block or in up to two blocks, as agreed with the manager.
- **Coordination:** Company paid parental leave runs **concurrently** with FMLA and with state paid family leave programs, which are coordinated so the employee receives pay

at a total of 100% of base pay for the Simtora-paid period; Simtora's benefit is reduced by state benefit payments received, where permitted.

- **Medical recovery:** birth mothers are also entitled to any additional disability leave for recovery (short-term disability or accommodation under the PWFA and ADA), which is separate from bonding leave.
 - **Notice:** please tell your manager and HR at least **30 days** before the expected start where possible.
 - **Return:** Employees who do not return at the end of their parental leave, other than for reasons beyond their control, are not required to repay pay received, unless state law or their individual agreement says otherwise.
 - **Return-to-work support:** flexible ramp-up, lactation support (time and a private space) and, in appropriate cases, temporary flexible working arrangements.
 - Employees accrue PTO and benefits during paid leave on the same basis as while working; unpaid portions follow the benefits guide.
-

6.6 Bereavement Leave

- **5 paid days** on the death of a spouse or domestic partner, child, parent, sibling, grandparent, grandchild, or in-law or step-relative of the same degree, or any household member.
 - **3 paid days** on the death of any other close relative or person close to the employee.
 - Additional time may be taken as PTO or unpaid leave, and Simtora will work flexibly with employees to support them (including after pregnancy loss, failed adoption or surrogacy and in other circumstances recognized by law).
 - Managers may request reasonable confirmation only where it's necessary, and in a sensitive manner.
-

6.7 Jury Duty, Military Leave, Voting and Other Leave

- **Jury and witness duty:** Employees receive their **regular pay for up to 10 working days** of jury service per year (subject to state law requiring more). Exempt employees are

paid in full for any week in which they perform any work. Employees must show the summons to their manager promptly and return to work when released.

- **Military leave (USERRA):** Employees who serve in the uniformed services are entitled to leave, reemployment and benefits protection under the Uniformed Services Employment and Reemployment Rights Act. Simtora provides up to **2 weeks of differential pay** (the gap between military and base pay) per year for annual training, and complies with any greater state obligations.
 - **Voting:** Employees who cannot vote outside their working hours can take reasonable, paid time to vote as state law provides; notify your manager in advance.
 - **Volunteer time off: 2 paid days per year** to volunteer with a charitable organization, scheduled with your manager.
 - **Domestic violence, crime-victim and other statutory leaves:** provided as required by the state or locality where you work.
 - **Workers' compensation:** employees injured at work are entitled to benefits under state law; see 4.3. Employees may use accrued leave to supplement benefits where permitted.
 - **Short-term and long-term disability:** provided under Company insurance plans (see benefits guide), coordinated with leave laws.
-

6.8 Unpaid Personal Leave

- Regular employees with **at least 12 months** of service may request up to **90 days** of unpaid personal leave for significant personal reasons not covered by another policy (for example, extended study, caring needs, or other personal circumstances), at the Company's discretion, based on business needs.
 - Requests are made in writing at least 30 days ahead (where possible) and need approval from the manager, Department Head and HR.
 - Job reinstatement is not guaranteed unless required by law, but Simtora will try to place the employee in a comparable position where possible.
 - Benefits continue as the benefits guide and plan terms allow; the employee pays their share of premiums.
-

6.9 Benefits Overview

Simtora offers a competitive benefits package for regular employees. Full details, eligibility and costs are in the current Benefits Guide and plan documents, which govern in any conflict.

Benefit	Summary
Medical, dental and vision	Group plans for employees and dependents; Simtora pays a substantial portion of premiums; coverage begins the first of the month after hire (or as plan terms state).
Health savings / flexible spending accounts	Available with eligible plans.
Life and AD&D insurance	Basic coverage paid by Simtora; optional supplemental coverage.
Short-term and long-term disability	Company-paid basic coverage.
401(k) retirement plan	Available from the first of the month after hire, with Company matching contributions as per the plan document (for example, a match up to 4% of eligible pay), subject to vesting rules.
Employee Assistance Program	Free, confidential counseling and support (see 4.4).
Wellness stipend	Annual stipend for wellbeing activities.
Commuter benefits	Pre-tax commuter benefit accounts for employees who commute to an office.
Equity	For eligible roles, see 1.5.
Learning and development budget	See 7.1.

COBRA and continuation coverage: Employees and dependents who lose eligibility for group health coverage may be able to continue coverage under COBRA (or state continuation laws) at their own cost; HR provides notices.

Plan terms: benefits are provided under plan documents, insurance contracts and applicable law; Simtora may change or end any benefit plan at any time, to the extent permitted by law.

Part 7 – Growth, Recognition and Support

7.1 Training and Development

Purpose. To provide the training and development that allow every employee to do their job safely and competently, to grow their skills and careers, and to keep Simtora competitive.

Scope. All employees.

Policy

- Training is a **two-way** process: Simtora provides opportunities and time; employees take responsibility for learning, practice and applying skills.
- **Mandatory training** (assigned through the learning system and completed by the deadline): security awareness, data privacy, code of conduct, anti-harassment, and role-specific safety or compliance training. Managers get additional training on hiring, reviews, corrective action and supporting employees.
- **Development opportunities** include on-the-job learning, coaching and mentoring, stretch assignments, internal courses and workshops, conferences, certifications (for example, cloud or security certificates) and external courses.
- **Learning budget:** each regular employee has an annual professional development budget of **\$1,500** (and **40 hours** of paid learning time) to use on job-relevant courses, books, certifications and conferences, with manager approval. Unused funds do not carry over. Larger programs (for example, degrees) follow the Education Assistance rules in the benefits guide.

- **Repayment:** for external programs costing more than **\$3,000**, employees sign a written repayment agreement that requires repaying a pro-rated amount if they leave voluntarily within 12 months of completion, to the extent state law permits.
(Repayment is not required for training the Company mandates for the job.)
 - Needs are identified through performance reviews and the Personal Development Plan (see 2.1). Managers must give employees reasonable time to train.
 - Employees are encouraged to share learning with colleagues, for example through tech talks and documentation.
 - HR maintains training records and reports completion rates to the Executive Team.
-

7.2 Internal Mobility and Promotions

- Open roles are posted internally. Employees may apply after **12 months** in their current role (shorter with manager and HR agreement) and while not subject to a final written warning or PIP.
 - Employees are encouraged to discuss their interest with their manager; employees who apply for other roles will not be penalized for doing so. Applying internally is confidential until a formal offer is made.
 - Promotions are based on demonstrated performance, readiness for greater scope, and business need, and are reviewed in calibration for fairness. Promotions take effect on the first day of a pay period and are recorded in an updated letter.
 - Career frameworks for each function define levels and expectations; they are available on the intranet.
-

7.3 Reward and Recognition

Purpose. To celebrate achievement, strengthen motivation and loyalty, reinforce our values, and encourage high performance and collaboration.

Policy

- **Peer recognition:** any employee may recognize a colleague through the recognition platform; points can be redeemed for small rewards.

- **Spot awards:** managers may give discretionary awards for exceptional contributions, within budget set by Finance. Cash awards are taxable wages and run through payroll.
 - **Team and quarterly awards:** nominees are proposed by managers and peers and selected by a panel of Department Heads and HR against criteria linked to company values, quantifiable results and collaboration. Categories may include **Employee of the Quarter** and **Employee of the Year**.
 - **Employee of the Year:** announced in **December** each year, with a trophy, public recognition and a cash award (**one month's base salary, capped at a value set annually by the Compensation Committee**, subject to tax withholding).
 - **Service awards:** recognition at 1, 3, 5, 10 and 15 years.
 - **Criteria and fairness:** awards follow published criteria, are free of discrimination, and are reviewed yearly for equitable distribution across teams and demographic groups.
-

7.4 Equipment, Home Office and Connectivity Stipend

Purpose. To ensure employees have the tools and workspace they need for safe and effective work, in offices and remotely.

Policy

- **Core equipment:** Simtora provides each employee with a laptop, peripherals appropriate to the role (monitor, keyboard, mouse, headset), required software and accounts. IT assigns, tracks, secures and supports all Company devices. Technical roles may receive higher-spec equipment as the role requires.
- **Home office setup:** hybrid and remote employees may claim a **one-time home-office allowance of 500 * *(and upto * *1,000** for fully remote employees) for ergonomic furniture and accessories, after the introductory period or earlier with HR approval, with receipts. Items bought with this allowance belong to the employee, unless they are classed as Company equipment. Ergonomic needs beyond this (including accommodations) are handled through 4.1.
- **Connectivity stipend:** employees who work remotely at least one day a week receive a **monthly stipend of \$75** for internet and mobile phone costs, paid through payroll and taxable where required. Employees in states where law requires full reimbursement of necessary costs will be reimbursed as required.

- **Mobile phones and data cards:** employees whose roles require heavy mobility or on-call availability may be offered a Company phone or a mobile-data plan, approved by the Department Head and HR. Company-provided devices and plans are for business use, with reasonable incidental personal use. Employees must not lend them to others. Loss or theft must be reported to IT Security immediately.
 - **Care of equipment:** Employees are responsible for reasonable care of Company equipment. Normal wear and tear is not the employee's fault. Replacement due to loss or damage is decided case by case; Simtora does not make deductions from pay for loss or damage except as permitted by law and with separate written consent.
 - **Return:** All Company equipment must be returned at separation or on request (see 9.4), using the prepaid shipping provided for remote employees, within **7 days** of the last day.
-

7.5 Hardship Pay Advance

- Simtora may, in its discretion, provide a **one-time interest-free pay advance** to regular employees who have completed **6 months** of service, to help with genuine unforeseen hardship (for example, an emergency medical, housing or family expense).
 - The maximum advance is **one month's net pay** (or a lower limit set by Finance), requires approval from the manager and HR, and is requested using the advance form **at least 5 business days ahead** where possible.
 - The employee signs a written repayment agreement authorizing repayment through payroll deductions in up to **6 equal installments**, subject to applicable law (including that deductions never reduce pay below minimum wage or reduce an exempt employee's salary in a way that the FLSA prohibits). Longer schedules may be agreed in special cases.
 - Only **one** advance may be taken per year, and not while a previous one is outstanding.
 - On separation, any outstanding balance is deducted from final pay only as state law allows, and is otherwise repayable under the agreement.
 - Advances are not an entitlement, and approval depends on the circumstances.
-

7.6 Relocation

Purpose. To provide reasonable financial and administrative support where Simtora asks an employee to relocate permanently, and to ensure consistent treatment.

Policy

- **Eligibility:** regular employees on the payroll, at levels below the Executive Team (whose terms are set individually), who are **asked by Simtora** to move permanently (for at least 12 months) to a location that is at least **50 miles** farther from their residence than their former work location. Relocation for an employee's own reasons is not covered, unless approved in writing.
 - **Approval:** All relocations need prior written approval from the manager, the Department Head and HR before any commitment is made to the employee. An **estimate form** must be approved before expenses are incurred. Exceptions need prior written HR approval.
 - **Covered expenses** (employee and immediate family members who live with them), within limits set in the approved estimate: transport of household goods, travel to the new location, temporary housing for up to 60 days, reasonable house-hunting trip, and, for homeowners, reasonable costs of selling and buying (up to a cap set by HR). A lump-sum option may be offered instead.
 - **Tax:** Relocation benefits are generally **taxable wages** under current federal law, and Simtora may offer a tax gross-up only where approved in the estimate.
 - **Claims:** submit itemized receipts to HR, marked "Relocation Expenses", separately from other business expenses, within **60 days** of the expense.
 - **Repayment:** employees who resign, or who are terminated for misconduct, within **12 months** of the relocation must repay a pro-rated portion of the relocation benefit, as set out in a written repayment agreement and as state law allows.
-

Part 8 – Business Travel

8.1 Business Travel Policy

Purpose. To ensure business travel is safe, cost-effective, and well-managed, and that employees are reimbursed fairly.

Scope. All employees traveling on Company business (customer visits, training, conferences, team gatherings, offsites) within the U.S. and internationally. Non-employee travel is governed by contract.

Principles

- Travel should happen only when the purpose cannot be met effectively by video or phone.
- Consider combining trips and traveling at times that reduce cost.
- Employees' safety comes first; employees can decline to travel to locations they believe are unsafe without penalty, and should discuss concerns with their manager.
- Travel time for non-exempt employees is paid as required by the FLSA and state law (travel away from home during normal working hours is working time, and travel is recorded).

Approval

Type of trip	Approved by
Domestic business travel within an approved budget	Manager
Domestic travel outside budget, or multiple trips	Department Head
International travel	Department Head and Finance (and Security for high-risk destinations)
Executive Team travel	CEO (CEO travel: Board Chair or CFO)

- Employees submit a **travel request** in the travel system stating purpose, dates, destination, estimated cost and business justification. A **travel request number** is required for all trips.
- Employees may travel to a maximum of **2 international training events per year** unless the Department Head approves an exception.

Booking

- All flights, hotels and rentals are booked through the **Company travel platform or approved travel agent**, to benefit from negotiated rates, duty-of-care tracking and policy compliance.
- **Book as early as practicable** (domestic: at least 14 days ahead; international: at least 21 days ahead; exceptions with manager approval).
- If an employee finds a materially cheaper fare elsewhere (at least 5% lower for the same itinerary), they may book it and claim it, provided the evidence of the comparison is attached.
- Frequent-flyer and hotel loyalty points may be kept by the employee, but choices must not raise costs above the lowest logical fare.

Air and ground travel

Traveler	Flight duration	Class
All employees	Under 6 hours	Economy
All employees	6 hours or longer	Economy or premium economy (business class with CEO/CFO approval for Executive Team members)
Executive Team	6 hours or longer	Business class permitted

- Rental cars: compact or mid-size; employees must use Company insurance or approved cover. Ride-share and taxis are preferred for short trips; personal-vehicle mileage is reimbursed at the current IRS business rate.
- Rail is encouraged where it is cost-effective and practical.

Lodging

- Stay at Company-preferred hotels where possible, in standard rooms, within the **nightly cap** published by Finance (based on the destination; capped at the GSA lodging rate plus 25% for high-cost cities, with exceptions approved by the Department Head).
- Extra nights for personal reasons are at the employee's expense.

- If an employee stays with friends or family, they may claim a **\$50 per night allowance** without receipts.

Meals and incidentals (per diem)

- Employees are reimbursed for reasonable meals and incidentals up to the **GSA per diem rate** for the destination (or the standard domestic rate), with receipts for any single meal above \$50. International travel uses the **U.S. State Department rates**.
- Meals provided by the Company or by a host (for example, at a conference or client event) are deducted from the per diem.
- **Alcohol** is reimbursed only when it is part of a client entertainment meal, in moderation and with a documented business reason. It is not reimbursable for personal meals.

Other expenses

- **Phone and internet:** reasonable work-related calls, data and Wi-Fi costs while traveling are reimbursed. Personal calls are not (brief check-ins home are allowed at reasonable cost). International data plans are arranged through IT.
- **Client entertainment:** requires advance approval, a named attendee list, and a business purpose; it must be reasonable and not lavish.
- **Personal or leisure travel:** any personal days added to a trip, and costs associated with family or friends, are at the employee's own cost; additional cost to the Company caused by them must be repaid.
- **Travel advance:** available on request for international trips or high expense trips; it must be used for business only and settled in the expense system within **10 days** of returning.

Claims and records

Submit the expense report within **30 days** of returning, following 1.6, with itemized receipts.

Safety, security and insurance

- The Company provides business travel accident insurance and emergency assistance for trips booked on Company business. Keep your itinerary up to date in the travel

system. Follow security advice for the destination, including any travel warnings.

- Carry and protect Company devices and data (see the IT Policy: use VPN, avoid public charging stations and unknown Wi-Fi, never leave devices unattended).
- Report incidents, illness, lost documents or safety concerns to the manager and HR or the emergency assistance line promptly.

Non-compliance

Claims that don't follow this policy may be declined. Misuse of travel funds may lead to corrective action and repayment.

Part 9 – Separation from Employment

9.1 Resignation

- Employees who decide to leave are asked to give **at least two weeks' written notice** to their manager and HR (more for senior or critical roles, as stated in the offer letter). Notice is requested, not legally required, given at-will employment, but giving notice helps ensure a smooth handover and is taken into account for rehire eligibility.
 - Simtora may accept the resignation with a **shorter or earlier** end date, may ask the employee to stop working and be paid through the notice period, or (in its discretion) pay in lieu of notice. Where Simtora ends employment immediately after notice is given, it pays through the notice period where stated in the offer letter or policy.
 - Employees who resign during an active corrective action or investigation should understand it may continue.
 - The manager and employee agree a **handover plan** (documentation, knowledge transfer, open work), and HR confirms the final date.
 - Resignation cannot be withdrawn without agreement from Simtora.
-

9.2 Termination by the Company

- Simtora may end employment at any time, with or without cause or notice, consistent with at-will employment and applicable law.
 - **Decision process:** every involuntary termination is reviewed by HR (and Legal where there are risk factors: recent leave, complaints, accommodation, protected activity, age, or group terminations) **before** it is communicated, to check that the reasons are lawful, documented and consistent with how others have been treated.
 - **Reasons** may include misconduct, unsatisfactory performance, failure to complete the introductory period, role elimination or restructuring, business need, inability to perform the job with or without reasonable accommodation, or loss of required authorization to work.
 - **Delivery:** The conversation is held in private by the manager and an HR representative, with a short written notice confirming the date, final pay, benefits, return of property and support available. System access is adjusted on the day, or before where security requires.
 - **Reduction in force:** Simtora complies with the **WARN Act** and state equivalents (for example, 60 days' notice for qualifying mass layoffs and plant closings, and state "mini-WARN" laws), and uses objective, non-discriminatory selection criteria reviewed by HR and Legal. Severance may be offered (see below).
 - **Severance:** Severance is not an entitlement unless stated in a written agreement or plan. Where offered, it is typically conditioned on a signed separation agreement and release (complying with the Older Workers Benefit Protection Act, with 21 or 45 days to consider and 7 days to revoke for employees aged 40 and over). Agreements never restrict protected rights (see 1.8).
 - **Gross misconduct:** employment may end immediately without notice or severance.
-

9.3 Job Abandonment

- An employee who is absent for **three consecutive scheduled working days** without notifying their manager or HR, and without a legally protected reason, may be treated as having **voluntarily resigned**.
- Before that decision, the manager and HR will make reasonable attempts to contact the employee (phone, email, emergency contact, and a written letter to their last-known address) to check on their wellbeing and allow them to explain. Possible leave, accommodation, safety or medical reasons are considered.

- If the employee does not contact Simtora within **three working days** of the written request, HR will confirm separation in writing. An employee who believes the decision was wrong may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 5 business days.
 - The department manager must notify HR promptly when an employee has not reported and not contacted the team.
-

9.4 Final Pay and Offboarding

Purpose. To make sure every departure is smooth, respectful, secure and compliant, and that Simtora learns from it.

Policy

- **HR checklist:** HR runs the offboarding checklist for every leaver: notice and final date, handover, benefits and COBRA notices, final pay, return of property, access removal, exit interview and record updates.
- **Final pay:** Final wages (including all earned wages, and any PTO payout where state law or plan requires it) are paid **by the timing required by the state where the employee works**, for example immediately on the day of termination or within 24-72 hours in some states. Otherwise, pay is issued no later than the **next regular payday**. Payment is by direct deposit or check, and a copy of the final statement is provided to the employee.
- **Deductions:** Only deductions allowed by law, or agreed in writing by the employee, are made from final pay. The employee's pay is never withheld to force return of property.
- **Return of property:** Laptops, phones, badges, keys, credit cards, documents and any other Company property are returned on or before the last day (remote employees use the prepaid return shipping provided). Employees may not keep copies of Company data, and must not retain confidential information (see 1.8). IT Security removes all system access **at or before the moment employment ends**. Personal information and files on Company devices should be removed beforehand; IT will not return them afterward.
- **Benefits:** HR provides written information on the end date of coverage, COBRA, 401(k) options, equity treatment (vested and unvested) and any other entitlements.

- **Continuing obligations:** reminders of continuing obligations, such as confidentiality and invention assignment, are provided in writing. Where the individual has signed a non-solicitation or non-compete, it applies only as state law permits (Simtora will not enforce a non-compete where state law prohibits it, for example, California, Minnesota, and other states, and complies with the FTC and state rules as they apply).
 - **Unemployment insurance:** Simtora responds to unemployment claims truthfully and does not contest eligibility without reason. Employees are provided with required notices.
 - **Records:** Personnel, payroll, and I-9 records are retained for the period required by law (I-9 forms: the later of 3 years from hire or 1 year after separation) and stored securely.
-

9.5 Exit Interview and References

- **Exit interview:** HR invites every leaver (voluntary or not) to a confidential exit interview or survey, ideally in the last week of employment, to learn about their experience and how we can improve. Participation is voluntary; themes are reported anonymously to the Executive Team. Anything raised about unlawful conduct or safety is acted on under 3.2 or 3.3.
 - **References:** To ensure consistency, all employment reference requests are directed to HR, which confirms dates of employment and job title and, where the former employee has given written permission, may confirm salary or other details. Managers must not give references on behalf of Simtora unless authorized, and may give personal references only if they make clear they are personal.
 - **Rehire eligibility** is recorded by HR based on conduct and performance, not on protected characteristics or protected activity.
 - **Alumni:** Simtora encourages positive relationships with former employees, and maintains an alumni network.
-

Appendices

Appendix A – Policy Acknowledgement Form

I acknowledge that:

- 1. I have received access to, and had the opportunity to read and ask questions about, the **Simtora Technologies, Inc. Human Resources Policy Manual** (version ____, dated ____).
- 2. I understand that I am responsible for reading and following the policies in this manual and any updates that are communicated to me.
- 3. I understand that this manual is **not a contract of employment** or a promise of employment for any period, and that my employment with Simtora is **at will**, meaning either I or Simtora may end it at any time, with or without cause or notice, subject to applicable law. Only the CEO, in a signed written agreement, can change at-will status.
- 4. I understand that Simtora may change, add or withdraw policies at any time, with notice.
- 5. I understand that Simtora systems and devices are Company property and **may be monitored**, as described in section 1.9, and I consent to such monitoring to the extent permitted by law.
- 6. I understand that nothing in this manual or in any agreement restricts my right to discuss wages, hours or working conditions, to report possible violations of law to a government agency, or to engage in other legally protected activity.
- 7. I know how to raise concerns (3.1, 3.2, 3.3) and that retaliation is prohibited.

Employee name (print)	
Signature	
Date	
Employee ID / Role / Location	

Retain the signed copy in the employee's personnel file. A digital acknowledgement through the HR system is equivalent.

Appendix B – Onboarding Checklist

#	Task	Owner	When	Done
1	Offer letter signed; background check and references cleared	HR	Before start	☐
2	Headcount record, payroll and benefits set up in HR system	HR	Before start	☐
3	Laptop, accounts, MFA and access prepared and shipped (if remote)	IT	Before start	☐
4	Welcome message to new hire; announcement to company	HR / Manager	Before start	☐
5	Buddy assigned; 30/60/90-day plan drafted	Manager	Before start	☐
6	Form I-9 Section 1 completed	Employee	Day 1	☐
7	Form I-9 Section 2 verified (within 3 business days)	HR	Days 1–3	☐
8	Tax forms (W-4 and state), direct deposit, emergency contact completed	Employee	Week 1	☐
9	Policy acknowledgement (Appendix A) and Confidentiality & Invention Assignment Agreement signed	Employee / HR	Day 1	☐
10	Welcome session and introductions; team introduction	Manager	Day 1	☐
11	Security basics; acceptable use; device setup confirmed	IT	Day 1	☐
12	HR induction: company, values, benefits, key policies	HR	Week 1	☐
13	Benefits enrollment completed (within plan deadline: typically 30 days)	Employee / HR	By day 30	☐
14	Required training completed (security, privacy, anti-harassment, code of conduct)			

Appendix C – Probation (Introductory Period) Review Form

Employee: _____ Role: _____ Start date: _____ Manager: _____
Review date: _____

Area	Rating (1–5)	Examples / evidence
Knowledge, skills and deliverables		
Quality and reliability of work		
Collaboration and communication		
Adaptability and learning		
Adherence to values, security practices and policies		

Strengths:

Areas for development / support needed:

Objectives for next period:

Recommendation: ☐ Confirm ☐ Extend (up to 30 days; reason and goals below) ☐ Do not confirm

Reasons / extension goals:

Resources and support the employee was given (HR to confirm):

	Signature	Date
Employee (signing confirms discussion, not agreement)		
Manager		
Department Head		
HR		

Employee comments:

Appendix D – Leave Entitlement Summary

Leave type	Who	Entitlement	Paid?	Notes
Paid holidays	Regular employees	11 holidays + 2 floating days	Yes	Calendar published January 1
PTO	Regular employees	15 / 20 / 25 days by service	Yes	Carry-over up to 5 days (state law may differ); payout per state law
Sick and safe leave	Regular employees	8 days (64 hours) per year	Yes	Carry-over up to 40 hours; state/local law may give more
FMLA	Eligible employees	Up to 12 weeks (26 for military caregiver)	Unpaid (may run with paid leave)	Job-protected; health benefits continue
Parental leave	Employees with 6+ months' service	12 weeks (primary) / 6 weeks (secondary)	Yes (100% of base pay)	Runs concurrently with FMLA and state programs
Bereavement	Regular employees	5 days (immediate family) / 3 days (others)	Yes	More time via PTO or unpaid
Jury / witness duty	All employees	Up to 10 working days' pay	Yes	State law may require more
Military leave	All employees	Per USERRA	Differential pay up to 2 weeks/year	Reemployment rights

	employees	Reasonable time as state law provides	Per state law	Give advance notice
Volunteer time	Regular employees	2 days per year	Yes	
Unpaid personal leave	Employees with 12+ months' service	Up to 90 days	No	Discretionary; approval required

Appendix E – Approval Matrix

Decision	Initiates	Approves	Informed
New headcount (budgeted)	Hiring manager	Department Head, HR, Finance	Executive Team
New headcount (unbudgeted)	Department Head	CFO and CEO	HR
Job offer and compensation	HR / Hiring manager	Department Head and HR (VP and above: CEO)	Finance
Out-of-band compensation	Hiring manager	Chief People Officer and CFO	CEO
Introductory period confirmation / extension / non-confirmation	Manager	Department Head and HR	Employee
Corrective action (verbal/written)	Manager	HR review	Department Head
Final warning / termination	Manager	Department Head and HR (Legal where risk factors exist)	Chief People Officer
Suspension	Manager	Department Head and HR	Chief People Officer
Promotion / role change	Manager	Department Head, HR, calibration panel	Finance
Fully remote arrangement	Employee / manager	Department Head and HR	IT Security
Work outside home state / country	Employee	HR (and Legal, Security and Finance for international)	Manager
Outside employment / conflict disclosure	Employee	Manager and HR	Compliance

Appendix F – Glossary

Term	Meaning
At-will employment	Either party may end the employment relationship at any time, with or without cause or notice, subject to law.
ADA	Americans with Disabilities Act.
EEOC	U.S. Equal Employment Opportunity Commission.
Exempt / non-exempt	FLSA categories: exempt employees are not entitled to overtime; non-exempt employees are.
FCRA	Fair Credit Reporting Act (governs background checks).
FLSA	Fair Labor Standards Act (federal wage and hour law).
FMLA	Family and Medical Leave Act.
GSA	U.S. General Services Administration (publishes travel per diem and lodging rates).
HR	Human Resources (People Operations).
OSHA	Occupational Safety and Health Administration.
PIP	Performance Improvement Plan.
PTO	Paid Time Off.
PWFA	Pregnant Workers Fairness Act.
USERRA	Uniformed Services Employment and Reemployment Rights Act.
WARN Act	Worker Adjustment and Retraining Notification Act (notice of mass layoffs and closings).

Appendix G – Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change	Approved by
1.0	September 30, 2026	HR	Initial release	CEO (September 30, 2026)
1.1	October 5, 2026	HR	Added "Locations outside the United States" and cross-references to the Global People Supplement (SIM-HR-002) and Country HR Manuals (SIM-HR-101 to SIM-HR-105); no change to U.S. policy	CEO (October 5, 2026)

End of document – SIM-HR-001